

Headstart
MENTORING

ROAD TO YOUR FIRST GRAD OFFER

IN AUSTRALIA



▶ STAGE 2: CONNECTIONS ◀



Based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured across Tech/Business/Engineering

YOU ARE HERE

STAGE 2: CONNECTIONS



STAGE 1: VISIBILITY			STAGE 2: CONNECTIONS			STAGE 3: QUALIFIERS		
JOB APPLIED	10 - 100		JOB APPLIED	50 - 200+				
INTERVIEWS	0-2 (The further you have gone is recorded interview stages/screening call)		INTERVIEWS	3-8 (A few screening calls + possibly 1-2 in person interview done)				
# OF PEOPLE HERE CURRENTLY	120,000 (40% of University Students in Australia (International + Domestic students in their Last Year) are here now)		# OF PEOPLE HERE CURRENTLY	20,000 (10% of University Students in Australia (International + Domestic students in their Last Year) are here now)				
CONSTRAINTS		TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE	CONSTRAINTS		TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE	CONSTRAINTS		TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE
HOW COMPETITIVE AS A CANDIDATE	You currently have 3 out of 4 things here: • Relevant Internship Experience • Strong Academic Record • Relevant Professional Certificates • Relevant Project/Project • Unique Personal Story But you don't know how to express them to maximise your chance to stand out	You are fully able to express your applications, they stand out	CONSISTENCY	Interviews come inconsistently and rarely, only once every 3 weeks after 50+ applications	Have 1 screening call/interview at least once every 3 weeks			
			APPLICATION METHODS	Mostly Online Applications, through platforms like LinkedIn, Seek, Seekgrad, Indeed, Uni Portal. Never through referral	Get 1 referral / introduction from someone in the company that you are applying to			
			COFFEE CHATS	Have tried reaching out to recruiters, but very rarely get a response or to talk to them	Reached out and have at least 3 calls/coffee chats with industries professionals, that are not recruiters/HR.			
			LINKEDIN CONNECTIONS	Currently only connected to peers from Uni who you don't even know (random connections)	Connected to 150+ industry professionals in your desired industry. Attempted to reach out to ALL of them.			
RESUME	You have a resume for your ideal role, but you get screened out most of the times	Have a well formatted resume that makes you stand out						
COVER LETTER	You have either use AI to generate generic cover letters, or tried hand writing, but the applications are still screened out	You leverage AI to generate a well formatted cover letter that makes you stand out						
LINKEDIN	You have an account, a profile picture, and some bare experience. But you have no idea if it is up to standard	Your LinkedIn clearly shows a chance in that industry						

0. FOUNDATION

1. VISIBILITY

2. CONNECTIONS

3. QUALIFIERS

4. FINAL BOSS



STAGE 2: CONNECTIONS			Headstart MENTORING
JOBS APPLIED	50 - 200+		
INTERVIEWS	Recorded Interviews: 3+ Screening Calls/Online Interviews: 3-8 F2F Interviews: 0-1		
# OF PEOPLE HERE CURRENTLY	43,200 (15% of International + Domestic students studying Business/Tech/Engineering in their Last Year are here now)		
CONSTRAINTS		TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE	
CONSISTENCY	Interviews come inconsistently and rarely, only once every 3 weeks after 50+ applications	Have 1 screening call/interview at least once every 3 weeks	
APPLICATION METHODS	Mostly Online Applications, through platforms like LinkedIn, Seek, Seekgrad, Indeed, Uni Portal. Never through referral	Get 1 referral / introduction from someone in the company that you are applying to	
COFFEE CHATS	Have tried reaching out to recruiters, but very rarely get a response or to talk to them	Reached out and have at least 3 calls/coffee chats with industries professionals, that are not recruiters/HR.	
LINKEDIN CONNECTIONS	Currently only connected to peers from Uni who you don't even know (random connections)	Connected to 150+ industry professionals in your desired industry. Attempted to reach out to ALL of them.	

Think you are not a strong enough candidate? Head to ‘Appendix - Page 1’ to see if you have at least 3 out of 6 strong traits.

WHEN YOU ARE AT: “STAGE 2: CONNECTIONS”

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Welcome to Stage 2 - you are already in the top 40% of candidates, having secured 3+ screening calls, and even 1-2 later round interviews. However, these interviews come inconsistently and are rare.

Your goal is simple: To explore how making connections and networking can actually unlock referrals.

HERE'S HOW YOU ARE LIKELY FEELING RIGHT NOW AND HOW THIS DOC HELPS



Conflicted

You feel closer sometimes, but it's that hope that kills you, after rejections from screening calls



Clarity

You are actually closer to getting consistent interviews, and you know it now

Frustration

You want feedback from that 1 failed interview but can't get it



Ease

You understand that your interview chances would be higher and more, so you let go even if you can't have feedback

Anxious

Always checking your gmail notifications to see if it's an interview invitation



Reassured

Rejections? Don't worry I have more chances for Interviews now!

MISCONCEPTIONS ON NETWORKING

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The advice is based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured by across Tech/Business/Engineering

You've probably tried connecting to recruiters for a role you have applied, and even sent a few messages to pitch for yourself. **I want to point out that this rarely works.** Everyone else also knows this trick, and the recruiters would be bombarded by messages after every grad role opening.



3 KEYS TO ACTUALLY CREATE NETWORKS THAT WORKS

EXTEND YOUR CONNECTIONS BEYOND RECRUITERS / HR

REACH OUT TO ACTUALLY LEARN + MAKE CONNECTIONS, NOT TO ASK FOR A JOB

CONNECT WITH PEOPLE IN COMPANIES WITHOUT DIRECT JOB OPENINGS

KEY 1



EXTEND YOUR CONNECTIONS BEYOND RECRUITERS / HR

Why?

Recruiters are always bombarded by connections and messages because they are the 'easy ones' to reach out, as they directly handle the application.

Reaching to other people in your field in the company is rarer, and they receive less connection request in general, increasing your chance of getting their attention and making connections

How?

1. Create a target company list based on your field + interest
2. Search each company on LinkedIn
3. Go to 'people's page' and filter out to the relevant field that are related to you.
4. Start Cold Connecting!



[To have a full step by step + industry expertise + personalised approach for you, click to book a free discovery call](#)



Bonus tips x2

1. It's also worth a shot to connect to the executives/directors/CEO of the company even if they are unrelated to your field (They are decision makers - **1 call with them is WORTH MORE than any other people inside the company**)
2. Cold connecting, unlike applications, should be a numbers game. The more connection attempts, the more chances you have to make real connections with industry professionals

KEY 2

REACH OUT TO ACTUALLY LEARN + MAKE CONNECTIONS, NOT TO ASK FOR A JOB

Why?

If you could help just one person, would you help a friend, or a complete stranger?

This also applies to networking, if we ever want to ask for referrals, we need to reach out and actually make a personal connection before asking for a favour.

How?

1. Send your new connections 1 concise message introducing yourself + asking for a coffee chat.
2. Don't ask for a job referral at the first 80% of the conversation
3. Ask them about their career journey instead
4. Get them to like you enough, so you can reach out for referrals in the future when the company has a vacancy

 [To gain a full step by step outreach template + personalised approach for you, click to book a free discovery call](#)



Bonus tips

1. Act as the **Listener** of the conversation, only speak 40% of the time max

We need the professional to feel good about themselves sharing their advices and helping us



They have a good and enjoyable time



They associate us with the good time they have



They would like us more, and be able to help act as a referer in the future

KEY 3

CONNECT WITH PEOPLE IN COMPANIES WITHOUT DIRECT JOB OPENINGS

Why?

You would genuinely come across as someone who is passionate and want to get into the industry, if your only intention is to learn from the person you are reaching out to.

This proactiveness increases your chances of actually securing the chat since the professionals would know you don't simply want a referral.

How?

Follows the same steps as [key_1*](#)

I SECURED A COFFEE CHAT, NOW WHAT?



We already learned that we are in the coffee chats to ask questions about the person, instead of for a job, what other basic principles should we follow?

- Always wear at least semi-formal wear
- Always thank them if they are buying you a coffee
- Prepare your resume on your phone to send if they are interested in helping you
- Feel free to ask them what they do outside of work
- Be yourself and just enjoy the coffee

TO ADVANCE TO THE NEXT STAGE, YOU HAVE TO:

1. Get 1 referral / introduction from someone in the company that you are applying to
2. Reached out and have at least 3 calls/coffee chats with industries professionals, that are not recruiters/HR.
3. Connected to 150+ industry professionals in your desired industry. Attempted to reach out to ALL of them.

P.S.

Building a network **doesn't happen overnight**. You'd only see results if you consistently reach out for at least 4 weeks.

Want to make sure you are maximising your chances and make less mistakes? We can help you make sure of that

 **SECURE A SPOT FOR MENTORSHIP WITH US,
BEFORE YOUR COMPETITOR FINDS US!** 

TO BUILD THE FOUNDATION, YOU MUST AT LEAST **ACHIEVE 3 OUT OF 6** OF THE FOLLOWING FEATURES OF A STRONG CANDIDATE

Based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured across Tech/Business/Engineering

1. Relevant Internship Experience



- Local internship preferred; one from home country also works, as it builds employer confidence you can do the job
- This is the "**juice**" to your resume/LinkedIn
- Virtual internships (e.g. Forage) don't count as valid internship experience to most hirers

2. Society Executive Role



- Being an Executive = leading a function of the society, sometimes managing sub-committees
- Gives you "real world experience" distinct from internships

3. 85+ WAM / Relevant Professional Certificates / Wins in Case Competitions



- Grades matter only above 85+
- A relevant, widely recognized certificate (e.g. CFA for Finance, CISSP for Cyber Security) makes a difference
- Case comp wins count if top 3 or similarly notable

4. Relevant Passion Project



- Showcases proactivity and interest in the field
- Must have **direct impact** on your daily life or social circle, **preferably quantifiable**
- AI can help execute the project, but *direct impact is non-negotiable*

5. Unique Personal Story / Fun Facts



- Everyone has unique stories
- Unique stories make you memorable among hundreds of applicants
- 1-2 relevant fun facts about yourself can help you stand out immediately

6. Australia Job Experience (can be casual roles/volunteering)



- Local experience is **KING**, it shows you can communicate with people in Australia
- Casual or part-time work reassures employers on communication skills
- No job? Volunteering works too, if done consistently (e.g. once every 2 weeks)

I DON'T HAVE 3 OUT OF 6 WHAT DO I DO?



We understand all features are not easy to obtain in a short period of time, especially for society exec roles, internships, 85+ WAM. **However, don't be discouraged as there are 3 things we can start TODAY!**

Unique Personal Story / Fun Facts



Fun fact: You already have them. You just need a third opinion to validate and point out these unique stories. Here is a practical step by step on how to extract them.

1. Write down every single memorable activity you have done since High School to Today
2. Write down your target field (ie marketing / accounting / software engineer)
3. List out 2 memorable incidents per activity, that is related to your target field
4. Find a person that is already inside the industry / have an internship at least
5. Present your timeline to them to ask them to highlight what is interesting about yourself (If you cannot find that person - [we can help you](#))

Time Required: 2-4 hours

Where can you utilise these unique stories:

- LinkedIn 'abouts' page
- Resume professional profile
- Interview answers



Relevant Passion Project

Please understand your passion project should not be 'Generic AI Slop'.

Here are some idea avenues that are accepted across every field:

- Non-assignment related academic researches
- Technical tools that enhances your life / life of your social circle (ie A finance tracker)
- Blogs / Articles posted regularly
- Business Ideas to make money (has to be related to your field, or a part of business that has to use your particular skills in your field)

Time Required: 3-4 weeks

Where can you utilise these unique stories:

- LinkedIn + Resume Experiences
- Interview answers

Key to a successful passion project:



1. **Must generate an impact/results**, ie:

- saved \$ amount of money
- got x amount of user
- got x amount of likes of a social media post
- made x amount of money
- got recognition from professor

2. **You must have worked a combined of 20+ hours towards the passion project.**

When you work hard towards a project, you'd actually gain the confidence in your hard work, and this confidence is the **difference maker, especially during interview stages. Trust us, we have talked to 600+ mentees, recruiters, managers - and everyone can easily tell if your passion project is some 'AI slop' or the real deal.**

Want to make sure your passion project actually contributes to you being a strong candidate? [We provide real expertise from industry professionals that made it because of passion projects, through 1v1 mentorship.](#)

Australia Job Experience (can be casual / part time roles / volunteering)

Casual / Part time roles



How to get a casual / part time job, 3 ways, ranged from Easiest to Hardest:

1. Text every single friend of yours in Australia if their part time work place has any vacancies
2. Online applications
3. Print a resume of your past casual job history, go to the suburbs near you, walk in every shop and introduce yourself + ask if you can hand a resume to the manager

To understand deeper the difference between casual job applications, or what to include in a casual job resume. [Book a free call here](#) so we connect you to a mentor who previously did a part time job.

Time Required: 4-8 weeks

Where can you utilise this experience:

- LinkedIn + Resume Experiences
- Interview answers

Volunteering

To find volunteering activities that are available, insert this prompt to your LLM of choice:

Context: I live in [Insert suburb and state]. I'm building a candidacy for [Insert field].

Task: Find 5 volunteer opportunities that could strengthen this candidacy.

Criteria (all must apply):

- In or related to [Insert field]
- Involves teamwork: regular interaction/collaboration with other volunteers, not solo work
- Easy to get accepted (minimal vetting/interview process)
- Can start within 1 month from today
- Ongoing/regular commitment (not a one-off event)

Output format per option:

- Name + hyperlink
- 1-2 sentence description
- Acceptance difficulty rating (Easy / Medium / Hard, with a one-line reason why)